NORTHSTAR
DIGITAL SERVICES

Employee Leave Policy

EMPLOYEE • MANAGER • HR

Policy document • Version 1.0 • Effective date: 15 October 2026

Prepared as synthetic content for a role-based retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) demonstration. This document is not an actual company policy.

Access classification: EMPLOYEE • MANAGER • HR

1. Purpose, scope and leave principles

Policy owner: HR

Purpose

This policy explains how employees request, plan, record and return from leave at Northstar Digital Services (a fictional company created for a demonstration). It aims to support employee wellbeing while helping teams maintain reliable coverage.

Who is covered

The policy applies to full-time employees unless a local employment agreement or applicable law provides a more favourable entitlement. Interns, contractors and temporary workers follow the terms in their individual agreements and should confirm eligibility with HR.

Core principles

Leave should be planned transparently, recorded accurately and handled consistently. Managers should consider business coverage without discouraging legitimate leave. HR interprets the policy and resolves inconsistencies.

Policy status

This is sample content for a role-based retrieval demo, not legal advice or an actual employer policy. Before real-world use, replace the fictional entitlements with approved company rules and applicable local law.

Leave categories

The sample categories are annual/earned leave, sick leave, casual or personal leave, public holidays, parental leave, bereavement leave and unpaid leave. Eligibility and balances may differ by work location and contract.

Employee responsibility

Employees should submit requests through the designated HR system, provide accurate dates and contact information where needed, and notify their manager promptly if circumstances change.

2. Requesting and approving leave

Policy owner: HR

Planned leave

For planned annual leave, submit a request as early as practicable. As a demonstration guideline, aim for two weeks' notice for absences of three or more working days and at least three working days for shorter absences. These notice periods are illustrative, not statutory requirements.

Approval workflow

The employee submits dates and leave type; the manager checks team coverage and policy eligibility; the system records approval or rejection; HR may review exceptions or disputes. A request is not approved until the system or authorized approver confirms it.

Decision criteria

Managers should use consistent criteria such as overlapping absences, critical deadlines, minimum coverage and the order or rotation rules established by the team. Decisions should not be based on protected characteristics, retaliation or personal favouritism.

Urgent or unplanned leave

For sudden illness or emergencies, notify the manager as soon as reasonably possible using the team's normal channel. If the employee cannot make contact, a trusted representative may notify the manager where appropriate.

Changes and cancellation

Employees should update or cancel a request if dates change. Managers should not alter approved leave informally without discussing the impact with the employee and documenting the reason.

Handover

Before planned leave, employees should document urgent work, deadlines, key contacts and the location of relevant files. Handover requirements should be proportionate and should not require employees to work while on leave.

3. Records, return and frequently asked questions

Policy owner: HR

Leave records

The HR system is the authoritative record of balances, requests and approvals. Employees should review their balances periodically and raise discrepancies with HR. Managers should not maintain unofficial spreadsheets containing unnecessary sensitive details.

Sick leave privacy

Employees should share only information required by company procedure or law. Managers generally need to know the absence duration and work-impact information, not a detailed diagnosis. Medical documents must be handled through approved confidential channels.

Return to work

After a longer or health-related absence, the manager may arrange a supportive check-in about workload, adjustments and priorities. Any required fitness or accommodation process should be coordinated with HR and applicable law.

If a request is declined

The manager should explain the operational reason, where appropriate, and discuss alternative dates. Employees may ask HR to review whether the policy was applied consistently.

FAQ: Can I take leave before approval?

Except where an emergency or law requires otherwise, wait for confirmation before treating planned leave as approved. For urgent absence, notify the manager and follow the reporting process.

FAQ: Who resolves a balance dispute?

HR checks the system record, relevant approvals and applicable rules, then explains any correction. Employees should provide dates or approval evidence rather than sharing unrelated personal data.

Review and ownership

HR owns this policy and reviews it at least annually or when laws, benefits or company operations change. The version published in the official policy repository takes precedence over downloaded copies.